

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, set against a light green background with a globe-like shape.

A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 56

INDIA's LAWS AND POLICIES - 4

NTCA AND PROJECT TIGER

- Project Tiger was launched in 1973 with nine reserves in 1973-74.
- The project was first started as a central scheme. Later, it was transformed into Centrally Sponsored Scheme, whereby Center and States share equal expenditures.
- The National Tiger Conservation Authority was established in 2005, following recommendations of the Tiger Task Force. It was given statutory status by 2006 amendment of the Wildlife Protection Act.



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WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT 1972



STRUCTURE OF NTCA



- Environment Minister is the Chairman of the NTCA.
- Below chairman are eight experts or professionals having qualifications and experience in wildlife conservation and welfare of people including tribals, apart from three Members of Parliament (1 Rajya Sabha, 2 Lok Sabha).



FUNCTIONS OF NTCA

- NTCA is the overarching body for conservation of tigers in India. Its main administrative function is to approve the Tiger Conservation Plan prepared by the State Governments and then evaluate and allow/disallow any ecologically unsustainable land use such as, mining, industry and other projects within the tiger reserves.
- As per the WLPA, every State Government has the authority to notify an area as a tiger reserve. However, the Tiger Conservation Plans sent by state government need to be approved by the NTCA first.
- Alternatively, Central Government via NTCA may advise the state governments to forward a proposal for creation of Tiger Reserves.
- Every year, the Central Government puts the annual report of the National Tiger Conservation Authority in each House of Parliament.



2 WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT 1972

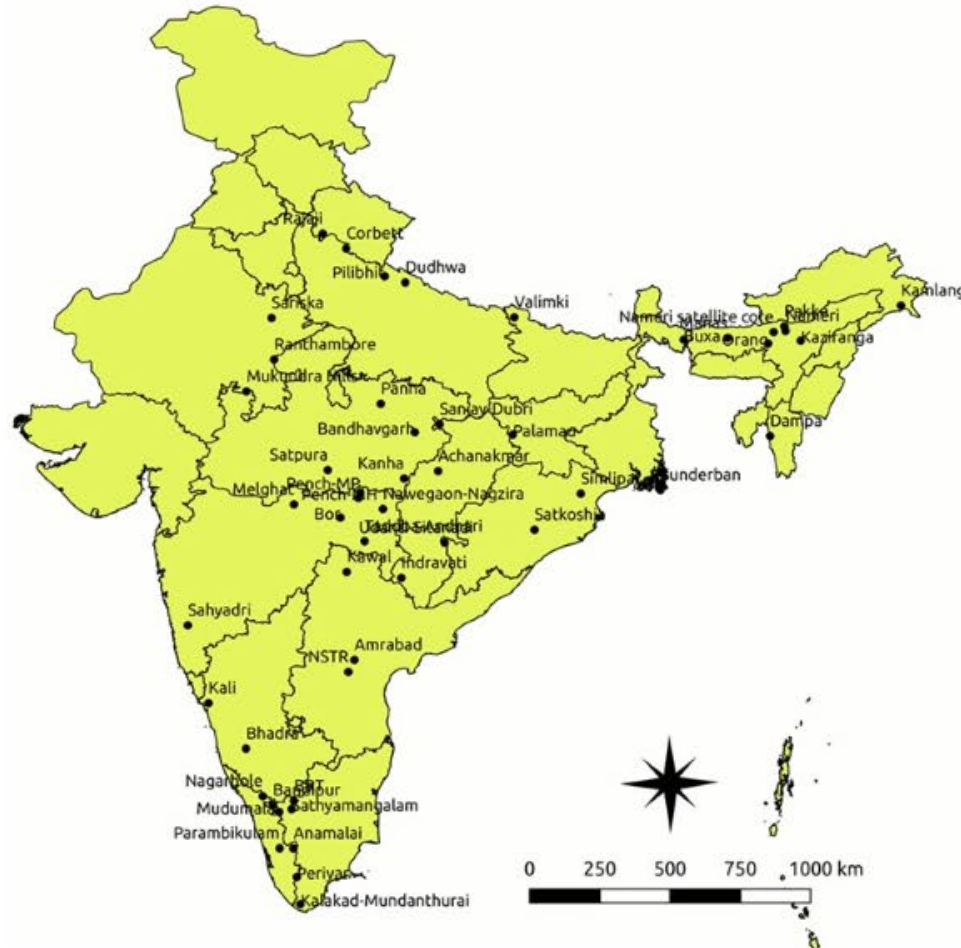
FUNCTIONS OF NTCA

- Other Functions of NTCA are as follows:
 - ✓ Regulation and standardization of tourism activities
 - ✓ Provide management measures for addressing conflicts of man and wild animals.
 - ✓ Ensure that the tiger reserves and areas linking one tiger reserve with another tiger reserve are not diverted for ecologically unsustainable uses, except in public interest and with the approval of the National Board for Wildlife.
 - ✓ Facilitate and support the tiger reserve management in the State.
 - ✓ Ensure critical support including scientific, information technology and legal support for better implementation of the tiger conservation plan.



2 WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT 1972

FUNCTIONS OF NTCA



Presently there are 51 tiger reserves, with a combined total area of - 72749.02 Sq.km





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2 WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT 1972

DECLARATION OF WILDLIFE SANCTUARIES AND NATIONAL PARKS

- The State Government may, by notification, declare its intention to constitute any area as a Wildlife Sanctuary or a National Park, if it considers that such area is of adequate ecological, faunal, floral, geomorphological, natural. or zoological significance, for the purpose of protecting, propagating or developing wildlife or its environment.
- The boundary of the Sanctuary/Park will be fixed by the state Government by a notification specifying the limits of the area which shall be comprised within the sanctuary and declare that the said area shall be sanctuary on and from such date as may be specified in the notification.
- No alteration of the boundaries of a Sanctuary/Park shall be made except on a resolution passed by the Legislature of the State, after the approval from NBWL/MoEF and NTCA (in case of tiger reserves).



2 WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT 1972

DECLARATION OF WILDLIFE SANCTUARIES AND NATIONAL PARKS

- The State Governments exercise complete control over all recognized forests. The state government's power to constitute reserved forests, national parks and wildlife sanctuaries is absolute but it has to seek prior approval of the Central Government for de-reservation, de-notification, diversion, logging, or leasing of forests for non-forestry activities.
- The Chief Wildlife Warden (CWLW) is the statutory authority, under the Wildlife Protection Act, who heads the Wildlife Wing of the Forest Department and exercises control over Protected Areas within a state.



EXAMPLE OF THE ROLE AND FUNCTIONING OF THE CWLW

- Prohibition of hunting-No person shall hunt any wild animal specified in Schedules I, II, III and IV.
- Hunting of wild animals to be permitted in certain cases - if the Chief Wildlife Warden is satisfied that any wild animal specified in Schedules I, II, III and IV has become dangerous to human life or is disabled or diseased beyond recovery, may permit any person to hunt such animal.
- Also, no wild animal shall be ordered to be killed unless the Chief Wildlife Warden is satisfied that such animal cannot be captured, tranquilized or translocated.
- The CWLW can also permit hunting of an animal for scientific research, except those in Schedule I.



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